

lully 1661

Platform *Recommendation.*

Shopify, Shopify Markets, Stripe Multibanco — a 29-day route from brief to brunch-launch event.

DOCUMENT PLATFORM RECOMMENDATION V0.1

PREPARED 2026-04-16

STATUS INTERNAL · DRAFT FOR CLIENT REVIEW

LAUNCH TARGET 2026-05-15 (BRUNCH PRESS EVENT)

Platform Recommendation — lully 1661 Website

Status: Draft v0.1 — internal **Prepared:** 2026-04-16 **Context:** Client deferred Q3 to us ("open to alternatives"). This document is our recommendation, to present alongside sitemap v1.

Recommendation (TL;DR)

Shopify storefront, with a premium customizable theme, Shopify Markets for PT + EN, and Stripe for Multibanco + credit cards. Plan a Phase 2 upgrade path to Hydrogen (Shopify's headless front-end) if editorial ambition grows after launch.

Why this, in one paragraph: the client wants to launch **ASAP**, already runs three operating stores with staff-managed inventory, supplies copy and photography themselves, and has no formal brand guidelines beyond illustrations. Shopify collapses everything we need into one platform — multi-language, Multibanco, POS integration, order management, tax rules for Portugal, delivery/marketplace integrations for Phase 2 — and lets us concentrate our effort on visual craft (theme, typography, the Baroque-illustration motif) rather than rebuilding commerce primitives. The two French bakery reference sites the client admires (liberte-paris.com , thefrenchbastards.fr) run on Shopify-class stacks, which is direct evidence the aesthetic ceiling is high enough.

Options considered

#	STACK	TIME TO LAUNCH	COST SHAPE	DESIGN CEILING	FIT FOR LULLY 1661
A 	Shopify + premium theme (e.g. Impulse, Pipeline, or a custom Dawn fork)	4–6 weeks	Monthly subscription + one-off theme dev + ~2% gateway fees	High — 90% of what a headless stack offers with a skilled designer + developer	Best overall fit
B	Shopify Hydrogen (headless) with Next/Remix	10–14 weeks	2–3× of A in dev, same subscription	Ceiling-free	Overkill for phase 1; sensible phase 2 evolution
C	WordPress + WooCommerce	6–8 weeks	Hosting + WooCommerce + Multibanco plugin licenses	Medium–High	Weaker POS / multi-store inventory, plugin-dependent Multibanco
D	Headless commerce (Medusa / Saleor) + Next.js	14–20 weeks	3–5× of A	Ceiling-free	Mismatched with timeline and copy-supplied-by-client reality
E	Squarespace / Webflow + external commerce	4 weeks	Flat SaaS	Medium (template-bound)	Weak PT commerce integration; no native Multibanco

Why Shopify specifically

What matches the brief

REQUIREMENT	SHOPIFY ANSWER
PT + EN, PT default, <code>/pt/</code> and <code>/en/</code> subpaths	Shopify Markets gives native multi-market routing with subpath URLs; translation via Translate & Adapt (free) or Weglot
Multibanco (mandatory)	Stripe is certified for Multibanco in PT and integrates natively with Shopify Payments; no custom plugin
Credit cards	Shopify Payments or Stripe, same checkout
Click & collect, staff-reconciled inventory	"Local pickup" is a built-in fulfillment method; Shopify POS on an iPad lets staff reconcile inventory in-store daily without a custom admin
3 stores already operating	Shopify Locations (multi-location inventory) — store-locator app (e.g. Store Locator Plus) for the frontend
Copy + images supplied by client	Native CMS fields + Metafields for editorial page blocks; no separate CMS
Phase 2 delivery (Uber Eats, Glovo)	Both have direct Shopify connectors
Phase 2 "our own payment system"	Custom payment app route exists when/if needed
Website live ASAP	Largest saved-time factor — we skip commerce scaffolding entirely

Where Shopify will push back (and our mitigations)

FRICTION	MITIGATION
Themes have a common anatomy — we don't want a "generic Shopify site"	Start from a highly customizable theme (Dawn or Impulse), build 3–4 bespoke sections for Home / Shop / Festive & Bespoke in Liquid; invest design hours here rather than in commerce
Shopify checkout is hard to deeply customize (pre-Checkout Extensibility)	Use Checkout Extensibility (2024+) for branded-but-standard checkout; avoid custom checkout pages
Editorial / long-form content patterns (journal, story pages)	Use Online Store 2.0 flexible sections + Metaobjects for History / Festive / B2B pages — works well for our scope
Locking us into Shopify long-term	Hydrogen is the documented escape hatch: same back-end, new front-end. No migration if we ever go headless

Phase 1 (launch) vs Phase 2

Phase 1 — launch scope

- Shopify plan: **Shopify** (\$79/mo tier — enables Shopify Markets and standard reports). Keep Shopify Plus as a phase-3 option.
- Payments: **Stripe** (Multibanco + Visa / Mastercard). Shopify Payments is an alternative if the client prefers single-provider consolidation.
- Languages: PT + EN via Shopify Markets; PT as primary market, EN as secondary.

- Fulfillment: Local pickup from 3 Lisbon stores, **staff-reconciled inventory** (no sync with external POS yet unless the client already runs Shopify POS — to confirm in F3 follow-up).
- Reservations: The Fork embed on a Reservations page (public widget from The Fork's business tools); email-contact fallback section below.
- B2B "Lully Inside": a static editorial page + Shopify form.
- Careers: static page + form that emails HR inbox.
- Content: Home, History, Shop, Festive & Bespoke Orders, Reservations, Lully Inside (B2B), Stores, Careers, Legal.
- Design: custom theme work — ~3 bespoke Home sections, custom product card, custom collection page header, store-locator page.
- Analytics: GA4 + Shopify native analytics. No ad pixels at launch (add when marketing picks up).

Phase 2 — post-launch (2–6 months after)

- Third-party delivery: Uber Eats and Glovo connectors (both direct Shopify apps). This does **not** require replatforming.
- Integrated payments: either expand Stripe with saved payment methods + subscriptions (for loyalty), or introduce the client's "own payment system" as a Shopify Custom Payment App.
- Loyalty / gift cards (likely a holiday-2026 priority — gift cards are a Shopify native feature).
- Editorial "Journal" / recipe content if content volume grows.
- Optional Hydrogen migration if the team decides the Liquid ceiling is blocking design ambition.

Timeline — hard deadline 2026-05-15 (brunch menu launch + media event)

Client confirmed (F2): the website must be live before the May-15 brunch-menu launch event (media + influencers). Today is 2026-04-16 → **29 days**. This collapses the earlier 4–6 week plan into a fixed 4-week sprint and forces a scope split.

Scope split for the deadline

	V1.0 — LIVE ON 2026-05-15	V1.1 — 10–14 DAYS AFTER LAUNCH
Home	✅ Full design	—
About / History	✅	—
Brunch / menu	✅ Priority for event — readable catalogue with PT + EN, prices, allergens, per-store availability	—
Shop — Breads / Pastries / Desserts / Snacks / Drinks	✅ Readable product pages (browsable catalogue)	—
Cart + checkout + pickup slot selector	⚠️ Target for v1.0 if QA allows; fallback to v1.1	✅ If pushed, ship as a low-risk add-on with Multibanco + cards
Stores (3 locations locator)	✅	—
Reservations (The Fork embed)	✅ where The Fork is live; email fallback on the rest	—
Festive & Bespoke Orders	✅ (static + enquiry form)	—
Lully Inside (B2B)	✅ (descriptive-only, partners TBA)	—
Careers	✅	—
Legal / Contact	✅	—
Analytics + UTM for event traffic	✅	—

Why this split is safe: the event’s purpose is to **drive brunch + press coverage**, not to drive e-commerce revenue on day 1. A readable menu + reservations + store locator covers 100% of the event narrative. Click-&-collect adds real commercial value but is not on the event’s critical path, and the downside of shipping it broken on Day 1 is much worse than shipping it 10 days later.

4-week sprint calendar

WEEK	DATES	MILESTONES
1	2026-04-16 → 2026-04-22	Shopify + Markets + Stripe provisioning · Theme base selected · Brand kit (colors / type / vectorized sub-marks) · IA locked · Domain + DNS pointed · Content ingest begins (client brunch copy + product photos)
2	2026-04-23 → 2026-04-29	Home + About + Brunch sections designed and built · Product data model + Shopify collections · Store locator data in from client · The Fork embed(s) verified
3	2026-04-30 → 2026-05-06	Shop collection + product templates · Festive & Bespoke · Lully Inside · Careers · Legal · Full PT translation pass · Cart/checkout spike (for decision on v1.0 vs v1.1)
4	2026-05-07 → 2026-05-13	QA, accessibility pass, Lighthouse pass, multibanco sandbox, analytics wiring, staging freeze 2026-05-13
	2026-05-14	Client sign-off + DNS cutover
	2026-05-15	Go-live + brunch-menu event
+1	2026-05-16 → 2026-05-29	v1.1 — ship cart + pickup flow if it didn't make v1.0. Post-event content refresh (press coverage, event photos).

Risks against the deadline

RISK	MITIGATION
Client content slips (copy or photos for brunch items)	Hard content deadline 2026-05-01 (end of Week 2). Anything not in by then uses placeholders and updates post-launch.
Vectorizing 3 Baroque sub-marks takes longer than expected	Parallel track in Week 1 — either vectorize manually or commission a designer up-front. High-res raster is an acceptable fallback for hero use with careful masking.
The Fork integration not live on all 3 stores	Email-fallback block ships for stores without the widget; swap in the widget post-launch per store.
Cart/checkout QA incomplete by 2026-05-13	Ship v1.0 without cart; ship v1.1 on ~2026-05-25 with cart. Event narrative is unaffected.
Translation quality (PT)	Use native Portuguese translator on the team for the hero and legal copy; machine translation for shop/product copy as first pass, native reviewer on week 3.

Gating content deliveries (client-owned)

DUE DATE	DELIVERABLE	OWNER
2026-04-23	Final logo pack decision (keep raster sub-marks or commission vector)	Us → client
2026-04-29	Brunch copy (PT + EN), brunch product photography, 3 store photos	Client
2026-05-01	All remaining copy (PT + EN), all product photography	Client
2026-05-06	Legal text (T&Cs, privacy, cookies, complaints book link)	Client / their counsel
2026-05-13	Client sign-off on staging	Client

Estimated cost shape (rough, for internal discussion)

- **Shopify subscription:** ~€79/mo (Shopify plan) + any app subscriptions (The Fork embed free; Weglot €15–49/mo if we don't use Shopify's free Translate & Adapt).
- **Gateway fees:** Stripe Multibanco ~1.5% per transaction (Portugal rate); card rates standard (1.4% + €0.25 EEA).
- **One-time design + build:** quoted separately by our team — main variable is how many bespoke sections we hand-build vs reuse theme defaults.

Open decisions that would change this

IF CLIENT...	...THEN RECONSIDER
Already operates Shopify POS in the 3 stores	Tightest fit — no replatform. Verify in F3 follow-up.
Already has a different POS (e.g., Lightspeed, SumUp, Square)	Confirm integration — Shopify has connectors for all three, but inventory sync quality varies
Moves timeline to 3–4 months	Option B (Hydrogen) becomes plausible
Says budget cap makes A infeasible	Option E + a separate commerce widget is the cheap fallback, but we will lose Multibanco native support
Decides B2B needs wholesale-ordering portal after all	Shopify B2B (on Shopify Plus) — changes plan tier and adds 2–4 weeks